

“Online shoppers benefit from the great variety, great deals and convenience of home delivery offered by e-commerce websites. Indian online buyers are buying everything from the latest laptop to a beanbag from the comfort of their homes, cyber cafes or even their mobile phones. E-commerce has great relevance in cities outside of the few where modern retail has penetrated. Consumers from these smaller cities, towns and villages now have immediate access to all latest gadgets and products immediately upon their launch” – Muralikrishnan B, Country Manager, eBay India.

Local Success Stories

There has been a proliferation of e-commerce sites in India with a majority of them working towards the ‘Master of All’ strategy where a wide range of products ranging from groceries and flowers to fashion and electronics are offered through their portals. Some of these recent success stories are Jabong.com and Yebhi.com

Jabong.com was founded in India in 2011 and is an online fashion and apparel store but also deals in furniture and homewares. Tagged as ‘delivering lifestyle’ within 4 months of launch of operations, the company has over a million page views daily and has an Indian rank of 66 on Alexa ratings which provides website analytics. When asked on how Jabong reduces the level of risk associated with shopping online, Praveen Sinha, Co-Founder of Jabong.com said, “Trust is an important factor in the buyer-seller relationship and this is especially so for the online community. To build customer confidence, we have introduced a 30 day return policy as well as the concept of open box delivery where we insist that the customer checks the contents of the package before accepting delivery”.

Yebhi.com, another popular e-commerce site founded in 2009, started by powering the sale of multi brand footwear online and later expanded into other categories like Apparels, Accessories, Bags, Jewellery and Mobile. In 2011, the company was awarded the ‘Highly Commended Website’ award by Online Retail Awards. Their business model is differentiated from other competitors as, “Yebhi.com deliveries are made by Yebhi Champs who as B-school graduates and offer all round support like product demos, installation, return or sales support. In comparison to others, we offer a 100 days return policy and have introduced a friendly ‘One-click automated returns’ as part of our user interface”, says Jatin Modi, Assistant Vice President: Business Strategy, Yebhi.com